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‘These animals deserved better’

Multiple belugas have died at Shedd Aquarium since rescue from Canada. Activists say the transfers happened too quickly

By Finnegan Belleau
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

More than three weeks have passed since the last beluga whales were transported from a shuttered marine park in Canada to Shedd Aquarium and other facilities across the U.S. and Spain. The dramatic rescues involved lifting the whales with cranes and flying them across international borders.

But since then, five belugas have died: Three who arrived at Shedd from Canada, one already living at the Chicago aquarium and another in Spain. Advocates for animal

well-being say a rushed transfer process may have contributed to their deaths, and they are worried about government approval of export agreements lacking commitments not to breed the whales.

“This situation should have been handled so much better from the start,” said Kaitlyn Mitchell, director of legal advocacy at Animal Justice, a Canadian nonprofit specializing in legal advocacy for animals. “These animals deserved better, and yet here we are.”

The international rescue effort moved 30 whales out of Marineland of Canada in Niagara Falls, Ontario.

Marineland’s owners threatened to euthanize the belugas if long-term solutions weren’t found, according to a previous Shedd news release.

Shedd took in 10 whales, with the others going to the Georgia Aquarium in Atlanta, SeaWorld San Antonio, SeaWorld San Diego and Oceanogràfic València in Valencia, Spain.

Eight belugas arrived at Shedd in July and August. Before the aquarium could rescue the final two, 23-year-old Peekachu died Aug. 25. The cause of her death is



A beluga whale is transported by a group of experts from Marineland and U.S. aquariums onto a truck via a sling at Marineland of Canada in Niagara Falls, Ontario, on Aug. 12. **CARLOS OSORIO/THE CANADIAN PRESS**

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Mayor Brandon Johnson speaks to media after the Chicago City Council meeting on Wednesday. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Mayor proposes Chicago data center moratorium

Johnson calls ordinance temporary pause to give city time to develop long-term policies

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson proposed a data center moratorium ordinance Wednesday aimed at blocking the controversial developments from popping up in Chicago for one year.

He described the ordinance, now in aldermen’s hands, as a temporary pause that would give the city time to develop long-term policies regulating concerns around pollution, water use and electricity costs. The city is “open for business,” Johnson said in a

statement, but “not for sale.”

“We welcome innovation, investment and the jobs and opportunities that come with it, but growth must be done responsibly and in a way that protects the health, safety and quality of life of Chicago residents,” he wrote in a statement before the measure was introduced in the City Council. “We are taking a thoughtful approach that will allow Chicago to embrace innovation while continuing to make our city safer and more affordable.”

Johnson’s moratorium push comes after he signed an execu-

INSIDE: Dueling tenants’ rights proposals stall as City Hall heads toward negotiations. **Page A5**

tive order early last month directing city departments to intensify scrutiny of new data centers. With his August order, Johnson established a city task force assigned with crafting new regulations.

At the time, the mayor also urged aldermen to pass a moratorium, but did not present such legislation. With his new ordinance, Johnson is now trying to take the local mantle of an

increasingly pressing political issue as he heads into his reelection campaign, while adding pressure on aldermen.

The 12-month ban would give Johnson’s administration time to research and establish new regulations, said Ald. Maria Hadden, 49th, City Council Environmental Committee chair. It’s “a year safeguard,” she said.

“Regulation takes time, and we’ve got to work on kind of catching up a little bit,” said Hadden, who is cosponsoring the legisla-

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An Idaho connection to Tylenol murders?

Authorities say man may be tied to 1982 case; Ill. investigators skeptical

By Rebecca Johnson
and Christy Gutowski
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

An unknown man walked into the Sacred Heart Catholic Church in Boise on Dec. 4, 1982.

He wore a Seiko watch, a leather belt and a bolo tie made of turquoise and silver. He carried a wallet but no identification. An envelope filled with 19 \$100 bills sat inside his shirt pocket. His hair was dyed and he had a deep tan, not common in the Idaho winter.

Within hours, he died by suicide inside the church. The cause was cyanide poisoning.

The Ada County sheriff’s office has spent decades searching for the man’s identity. At a Wednesday morning news conference, they announced they’ve uncovered the identity of the “Unknown Wanderer” and that he may be connected to the 1982 Tylenol murders. Illinois investigators, however, remain highly skeptical, pointing to a lack of physical evidence.

“The reliance on psychological profiles to prove a crime is no more reliable than the reliance of tarot cards or seeing how chicken bones line up in the dirt,” said former federal prosecutor Jeremy Margolis, who was a key player in the original task force in 1982.

Seven Chicago-area residents died after swallowing Tylenol capsules laced with potassium cyanide in September 1982. Widely regarded as an act of domestic terrorism — a term not in the country’s vernacular at the time — the murders led to tamper-evident packaging, copycat killings and myths about tainted Halloween candy. No one has been charged with the murders. The lone suspect

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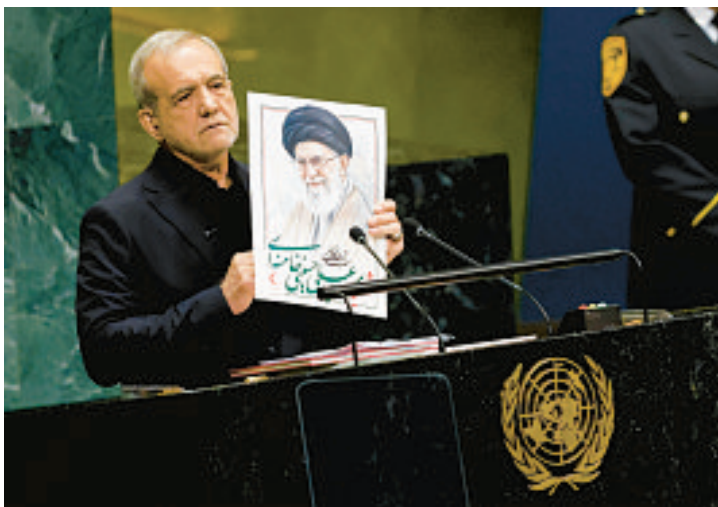
INSIDE

Cubs home in on playoffs in final week

C Alex Bregman’s return after multiple facial fractures and a nor’easter could bring a dramatic pause to the Cubs’ final weekend. **Sports**

Chocolate retailer expands nationwide

Chicago-based Hotel Chocolat is going coast-to-coast with airport concessions, grocery stores and new retail markets. **Business**



Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian holds an image of late Ayatollah Ali Khamenei on Wednesday. **STEFAN JEREMIAH/AP**

Iran leader strikes defiant tone during speech at UN

Pezeshkian calls out Trump, says nation will not be bullied

By Farnoush Amiri
ASSOCIATED PRESS

UNITED NATIONS — Iran’s president said Wednesday that his people have been “victims of terrorism” by the United States, delivering a rare wartime speech at the U.N. General Assembly a day after President Donald

Trump said he may “annihilate” the Islamic Republic if a deal isn’t reached soon to end the nearly seven-month war.

The defiant speech by President Masoud Pezeshkian marked a striking instance of a foreign leader addressing the world body while their country is at war with the host nation. While defending his country, Pezeshkian held up large photos of the late Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and the

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